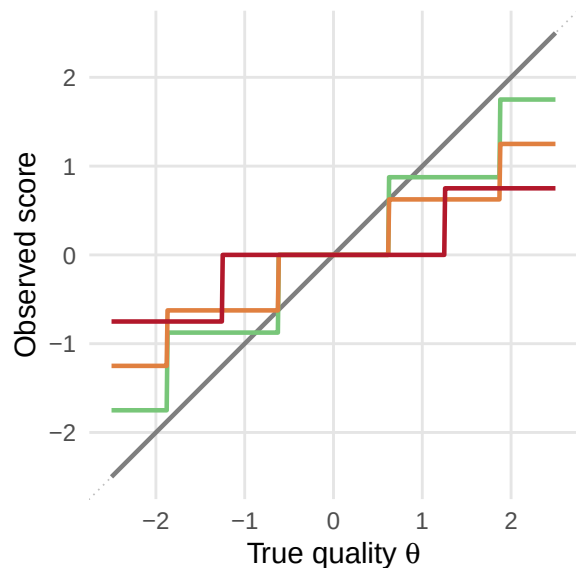


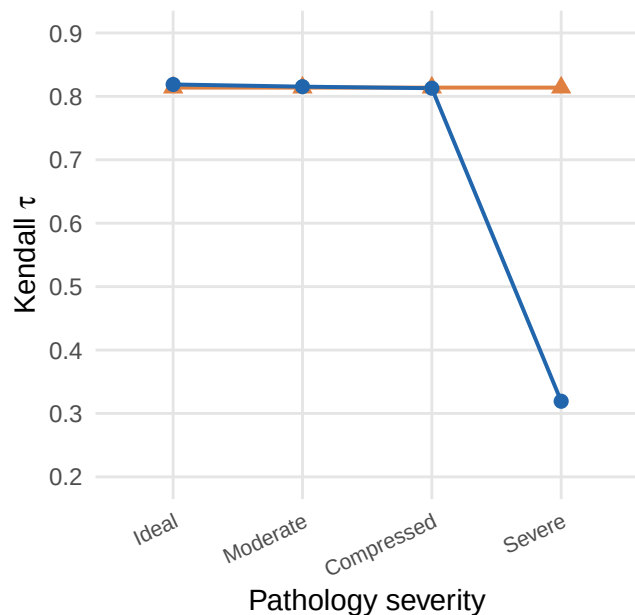
The Decomposition's Blind Spot: Non-linear Scoring Distortions

Likert pathologies distort the scoring function (left), degrading rankings (right). Pairwise BT is immune.

(a) Likert scoring function



(b) Ranking recovery (τ with ground truth)



— Ideal (continuous) — Compressed (k=0.5, 5-pt)
— Moderate (k=0.7, 5-pt) — Severe (k=0.3, 3-pt)

▲ BT (tournament) ● Likert mean